

ch-1 Natural resources and their use

Notes

→ What are Natural resources?

→ Natural resources are substance from nature that are valuable to humans. A substance becomes a 'Resources' only when it meets three criteria:

→ Technologically Accessible: We have the tools to reach or use it.

→ Economically Feasible: it is not too expensive to extract or use.

→ Culturally Acceptable: Its use does not violate local tradition or values (e.g. Sacred groves)

• Classification of natural resources

→ Essential for life: Air, water and soil (cannot be made by humans).

→ For Material: Wood, marble and metal used to create objects of utility.

→ For energy: Coal, petroleum, Sunlight and wind used for electricity and transport.

• Based on Renewability

→ Renewable: Can be naturally restored or regrown (e.g. Sunlight, wind, forests). They remain renewable only if used so that nature can replace.

→ Non-Renewable: Formed over millions of years and cannot be replaced once used (e.g. coal, oil).

- Key concept

- **Nature cycle :-** Nature has properties of restoration (Healing) and Regeneration (creating new life) over-exploitation disrupt these cycle.
- **Human Impact :-** Activities like overfishing or overpumping ground water disrupt these natural cycles, leading to resources depletion.